

COLORADO FIELD ORNITHOLOGISTS - SIGHT RECORD FORM

NEW STATE RECORD _____ UNUSUAL RECORD X

CFO-ORC FILE #

2000 - 50

7-0 (A)

Recd 1/29/01 ugpl

Species: Black-headed Gull (*Larus ridibundus*)

Date: 9 October 2000

Number seen: one

Sex: unknown

Plumage: adult basic

Locality: Barr Lake State Park

Elevation: 5,000 ft.

Nearest town: Brighton

County: Adams

Time observed: ~1450-1510 hrs (MDT)

Duration of observation: ~20 minutes

Description:

Seen with Ring-billed (*L. delawarensis*) and Franklin's (*L. pipixcan*) gulls for side-by-side comparison. Body size almost exactly in between Franklin's and Ring-billed; light gray upperparts more closely resembling that of ring-billed. Bill long and thin of dusky red coloration, head white with large black ear patch and some dusky gray on the crown and nape (resembling Bonaparte's Gull *L. philadelphia*), legs deep red and long (body feathers distant from ankles, much higher than Franklin's standing next to it), tail entirely white and long (again longer than Franklin's); wingtips dark with thin, white fringing on folded wing; in flight, upperwing had a large, white, unbroken wedge extending from the "wrist" and spreading out among the outer primaries, black border on the outer primaries extending from the forewing (frontal edge of the outermost primary) around the outer primary tip to the hind wing along the inner primaries tips. The black extended inwardly on the inner primaries from their tips ~1/6th the length of the feathers (this is a rough estimate). From below, the outer primaries had extensive white mirrors, with the outermost primary mirror extending through about half of the feather. This feature could also be seen on the underside of the wing opposite us while looking at the standing bird.

Describe the bird's song and call, if given, including method of delivery (i.e. from perch, in flight, duration): I heard none.

What is your prior experience with this and similarly-appearing species? No prior experience.

Light conditions: sky clear, sun high, in front and right

Optical equipment used: Kowa scope 20-60x

Distance, and how estimated: 250 meters

Other observers who saw the bird with you: Tony Leukering

Other observers who saw the bird independently: none that I'm am aware of

If photographed, type of equipment and film: I did not photograph

List books, illustrations, recordings, other birders, etc. consulted and how this influenced your identification:

a) at time of observation: none

b) after observation: Nat. Geo. 2nd ed. Field Guide to the Birds of North America
Peter Harrison. Seabirds. 1983

Reporting observer: Doug Faulkner

Signature: Doug Faulkner

Address: Rocky Mountain Bird Observatory, 14500 Lark Bunting Lane, Brighton, CO 80601

Date report was written: This report was written on 10 January 2001 directly from notes taken immediately after observation.